

Πατροκλῆς ὁ Θούριος

Fate and Fortune in the Comedy of Patrocles of Thurii

eul_aid: gmc

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Δράμα Ἀττικόν* [Attic Drama](#)
Domain: *Δρᾶμα* [Drama](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Patrocles of Thurii was a 4th-century BCE comic playwright from the panhellenic colony of Thurii in Magna Graecia. His floruit places him within the era of Middle Comedy. As a non-Athenian poet, he likely traveled to Athens to compete at dramatic festivals like the Dionysia, though no further biographical details are recorded.

A single comedy, *Dionysos*, is attributed to him. The play is lost, surviving only by title and in a one-line fragment preserved by the grammarian Athenaeus. Patrocles is a minor figure, known only from a single citation in the *Suda*. His significance lies as a data point demonstrating the geographical spread of comic poets and the participation of non-Athenians in Athenian theatrical culture. The title *Dionysos* suggests a thematic connection to the god of the festival, but the extant fragment is too scant for further analysis.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [On the Vicissitudes of Fate](#) · 5 passages